BLUE FAIRY DEVELOPMENT

BlueFairy Performance Kit

Removing the front-end weight WordPress adds by default

Version 1.1.0 · GPL-2.0-or-later · WordPress 6.6+ · PHP 8.1+
bluefairydevelopment.com

BlueFairy Performance Kit — Feature Guide

Version 1.1.0 | GPL-2.0-or-later | PHP 8.1+ | WordPress 6.4+

WordPress ships front-end JavaScript and CSS that most sites never use. This plugin takes it out, adds lazy loading for iframes, and otherwise stays out of your way. Everything is on after activation and there is nothing you must configure.

Emoji removal



The document head, with the emoji and oEmbed payload gone

WordPress loads a detection script and a stylesheet on every page so it can replace emoji characters with images on browsers that cannot render them. That was worth doing in 2015.

Removed: the detection script from the front end, the admin and embeds; the emoji stylesheet on all three; the feed and RSS comment filters; the email filter; the TinyMCE plugin; and the `s.w.org` DNS-prefetch hint.

> **This was broken before 1.1.0.** WordPress now enqueues emoji styles through `wp_enqueue_emoji_styles()` and unhooks the older `print_emoji_styles()` itself, so a plugin that removes only the old callback leaves the stylesheet loading. Both paths are removed now.

Your emoji still display. They are ordinary Unicode characters and the device renders them; only WordPress's detection machinery goes.

---

oEmbed removal

Two things are removed from the front end:

- The oEmbed **discovery links** in `<head>` — the metadata that lets other sites embed your posts.
- The **`wp-embed` script**, which powers embeds of *other* sites' content inside your pages.

Pasting a YouTube or Twitter URL into the editor still produces an embed.

> **This was broken before 1.1.0 too.** WordPress binds `wp_oembed_add_discovery_links` at `wp_head` priority 4, and `remove_action()` defaults to priority 10, so the removal silently did

nothing and the links were printed on every singular page.

Front-end heartbeat

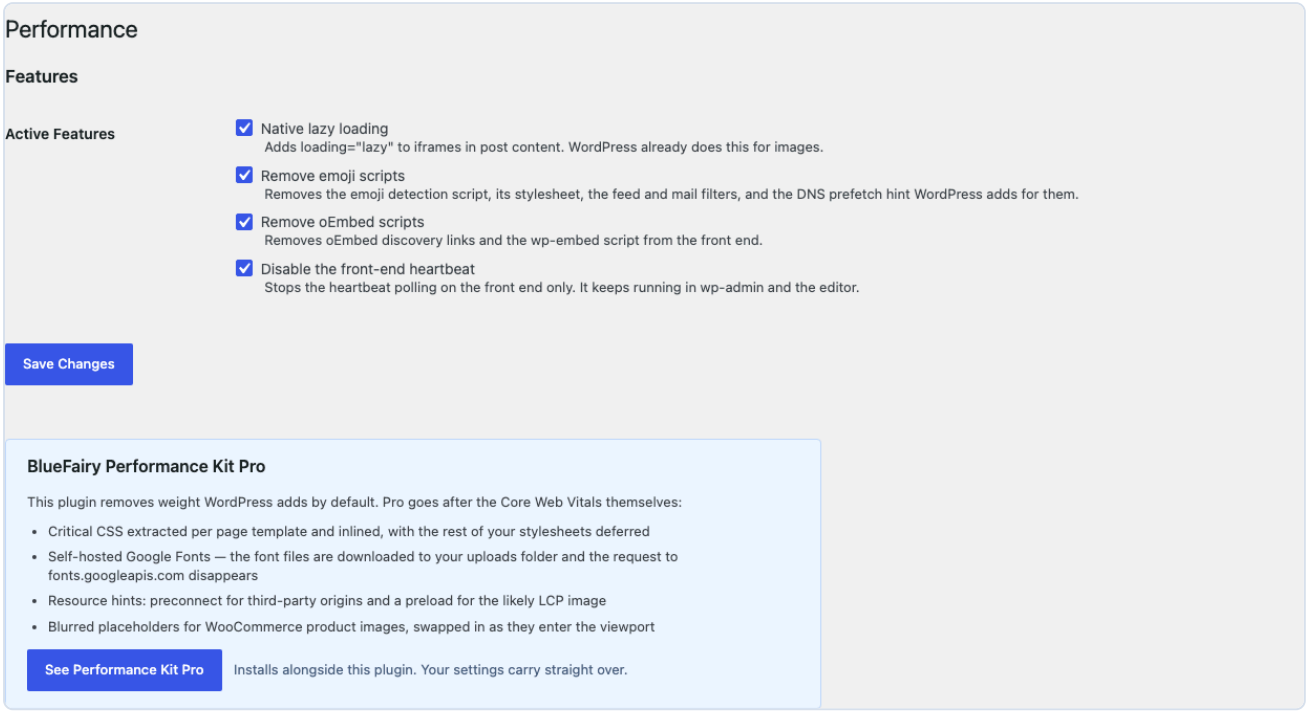
The WordPress heartbeat polls `admin-ajax.php` on an interval. In wp-admin that drives autosave, post locking and session warnings. On the front end, for a visitor who will never open wp-admin, it does nothing but consume requests.

The heartbeat script is deregistered on `wp_enqueue_scripts`, which does not run in wp-admin or the block editor — so autosave and post locking are untouched.

Lazy loading

WordPress already adds `loading="lazy"` to images. It does not add it to iframes in post content, which is where an embedded video or map sits. This plugin adds it to any iframe that does not already carry a `loading` attribute.

Settings



Settings > Performance — one switch per optimisation, all on by default

Settings → Performance. One checkbox per optimisation, with a sentence explaining what it does. All four are on after activation.

Turning one off unbinds it completely — nothing is left running.

Conflict detection

If WP Rocket, LiteSpeed Cache, W3 Total Cache, Autoptimize, WP Super Cache or SiteGround Optimizer is active, the settings page says so and names it.

Nothing breaks when both are on; the work is simply done twice. Switch off whichever half you prefer. The check runs on every request, so it reflects what is active now rather than what was active when this plugin was installed.

Uninstalling

Deleting the plugin removes the three options it created. It stores nothing else — no tables, no files, no transients.

What Performance Kit Pro adds

This plugin removes weight WordPress adds. Pro goes after the Core Web Vitals themselves. It installs **alongside** this plugin rather than replacing it — your settings carry over, and these four optimisations keep working exactly as they do now.

Feature	Performance Kit Pro	Performance Kit (this plugin)
`loading="lazy"` on iframes in post content	Yes	Yes
Emoji scripts, styles, feed and mail filters removed	Yes	Yes
oEmbed discovery links and the `wp-embed` script removed	Yes	Yes
Front-end heartbeat disabled	Yes	Yes
Settings page with per-feature toggles	Yes	Yes
Conflict detection for six caching plugins	Yes	Yes
Critical CSS extracted per template and inlined	Yes	—
Remaining stylesheets deferred, with a `<noscript>` fallback	Yes	—
Optional headless browser endpoint for real above-fold CSS	Yes	—
Google Fonts downloaded and served from your own domain	Yes	—
The request to `fonts.googleapis.com` removed entirely	Yes	—
`preconnect` for third-party origins the page actually loads	Yes	—
`preload` for the likely LCP image	Yes	—
A `prefetch` for the likely next page	Yes	—
Blurred placeholders for WooCommerce product images	Yes	—
`srcset` repair and `sizes` defaults	Yes	—
Background queue with retries, status panel and WP-CLI	Yes	—
Feature toggles on the settings page	8	4

What the missing rows cost you

Your stylesheets block the first paint. Every CSS file in `<head>` must download and parse before the browser draws anything. Pro inlines the CSS that page template needs and defers the rest, so the first paint stops waiting on the network.

Every Google Font is a third-party round trip. A DNS lookup, a TLS handshake and two requests to a domain you do not control, before any text renders. Pro downloads the woff2 files into your uploads folder and serves them from your own domain, and the request to `fonts.googleapis.com` disappears.

The browser discovers your biggest image last. The LCP image is usually found only after the HTML and CSS have parsed. Pro preloads it, and preconnects to the third-party origins your page really uses.

Honest limits

Two things Pro does **not** do, so you are not surprised:

- The built-in critical CSS extractor is a best-effort fallback. It keeps every rule whose selector appears in your markup, which on a block or WooCommerce theme is most of the stylesheet — and it refuses to inline more than 50 KB, because that would make pages slower. A headless browser endpoint is the route to a real above-fold result.
- The image placeholders are **WooCommerce product images only**, and the placeholder is your existing thumbnail with a CSS blur rather than a generated low-quality image. On a site without WooCommerce that feature does nothing.

Get Pro

https://wordpress.bluefairydevelopment.com/product/bluefairy-performance-kit-pro/

One payment, no subscription. Pro requires this plugin to be installed and active — it is an add-on, not a replacement.